10.10 The Neutropenic Patient*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "Why must I wear a mask and avoid visitors?" **Objective** • Neutrophils 0.5 × 10^9/L • Recent chemotherapy	**ACTUAL** Inadequate health knowledge related to infection prevention during neutropenia as evidenced by questioning.	• Describes infection precautions within 24 hours.	• Explain neutropenia and when counts are expected to be lowest. • Teach hand hygiene and food safety: well-cooked food, washed fruit. • Tell her to report a temperature of 38 °C or more straight away.	• Outcome reached when she describes the precautions.
Subjective • "I feel lonely in this room." **Objective** • Protective isolation • Few visitors	**ACTUAL** Inadequate social connectedness related to protective isolation as evidenced by expressed loneliness.	• Feels less lonely.	• Visit regularly for contact that is not tied to a task. • Encourage phone and video calls. • Allow healthy visitors who follow the precautions.	• Considered met as loneliness lessens.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Severe neutropenia • Central line in place	**RISK** Risk for infection as evidenced by risk factors: neutropenia and invasive device.	• No infection.	• Check the mouth, skin, perianal area and line each day. • Keep invasive procedures to a minimum. • Give growth factor as prescribed.	• Goal reached if no infection develops.

* **References for this care plan:** [22], [32], [35], [63]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.